



The People of Europe

THE VAST MAJORITY of Europeans enjoy good health

and material comfort in comparison to those in the non-Western world. Yet, in this largely urban, materialistic environment people suffer from loneliness in a way unthinkable in places where extended family groups and a more tightly knit community structure are the norm.

CITY LIVING

Around three-quarters of Europeans live in cities where they enjoy a high standard of living. Many are unfamiliar with the countryside, agriculture, or farming, instead buying everything they need from stores.

Compared to children in other parts of the world, European children are rarely allowed out unaccompanied by adults.

THE EUROPEAN UNION



EU Flag



The euro

A UNITED EUROPE?

The EU started in 1957 when Belgium, France, Italy, Germany, Luxembourg, and the Netherlands formed the European Economic Community (EEC) to improve trade and cooperation between their countries. In 1993 it became the European Union, and it currently has 15 members, 12 of which share a currency, the euro.

CULTURAL MIX

Europe's big cities are blessed with a tremendous mix of people. Migrants, particularly from Europe, Africa, and Asia, have had a major impact on the human face of the continent. As well as adding their numbers to the workforce, immigrants have also enriched Europe with their food, music, and religious customs.

